

GALA DINNER

Power and Pandora



SUBIR HALDER/www.indiatodayimages.com

Director James Cameron of *Avatar* fame almost created a brave new world while delivering the keynote address at the INDIA TODAY Conclave 2010 gala dinner. He took the audience, and an awestruck Aamir Khan, to the near fantasy planet of 3-D movie-making and what it means for the future of cinema. Ranbir Kapoor and Prasoon Joshi were equally enraptured with the presentation. Director Vidhu Vinod Chopra had flown down just to hear Cameron and the two engaged in an animated discussion. As Videocon Chairman Venugopal Dhoot said after the Cameron-Khan session, "It was truly astonishing, the qual-

ity of the discussion. I know I was in Delhi but I could have been in Los Angeles."

It happened to be the eve of Khan's birthday and he was asked to cut the surprise birthday cake while the champagne corks popped. Yet, for once he was upstaged; by the man who has made the two highest grossing films of all time, *Avatar* and *Titanic*. Cameron was the most sought after speaker after Salman Rushdie, with a queue of people lining up to get his autograph. However, one man who didn't queue up was Nassim Nicholas Taleb, author of the best-selling book *Black Swan* and a fellow speaker who was overheard whispering: "I think the Khan guy has